

Life skills
strategy

Being a positive influence

If you want to persuade people to make positive changes or decisions,

- be positive and offer practical suggestions.
- listen and try to see things from their point of view.
- lead by example, giving examples from your life and other people's lives.

1 Study the life skills strategy. Then do the quiz.



Are you a
positive
influence?
TRY OUR QUIZ
AND FIND OUT!

1 Your friend has an annoying habit: she checks her phone messages all the time. Do you ... ?

- A criticize her in front of other friends
- B talk about a bad habit you once had and how you dealt with the problem
- C spend less time with her

2 Your cousins have a new YouTube channel. You think their videos are terrible. Do you ... ?

- A suggest that they give up
- B offer to help them improve the videos? They trust you, so they will listen
- C tell them you think they're great, but don't follow them

3 A friend disagrees with you about a homework assignment. He's stubborn and won't listen to you. What do you say?

- A "Sorry, but I know I'm right."
- B "I may be wrong. Let's look at the facts." Then justify your opinion.
- C Nothing. You don't like arguing with your friends.

4 You're doing your homework, but your brother put on loud music. Do you ... ?

- A go into his bedroom and switch off his music yourself
- B explain why it's a problem and convince him to turn it down
- C try to ignore it and carry on working

5 A friend posts an embarrassing picture on social media. Do you ... ?

- A tell her that the picture is really stupid
- B explain how people might react and talk her into taking it down
- C do nothing, but feel guilty about it

KEY

MOSTLY As You don't try to influence people – you prefer to tell them directly what to do. But people won't listen to you if you're rude.

MOSTLY Bs You politely say what you think, but you can see things from other people's point of view, too. You are a positive influence!

MOSTLY Cs You don't like disagreements. Consider influencing people to do the right thing sometimes.

Discover vocabulary Influencing

Student Book ► page 112 Workbook ► page 8



2 Work in pairs and compare your answers for the quiz. Were they similar or different? Do you agree with the key?



1.02

3 You are going to listen to a podcast about YouTubers. In pairs, discuss how YouTubers influence their followers. Then listen. Which ideas are mentioned?

- 1 They give their followers advice.
- 2 They offer them free products.
- 3 They share personal information.
- 4 They are good listeners.
- 5 They have a lot of expert knowledge.
- 6 They influence people in a positive way.



Listening
strategy

Answering multiple-choice questions

When you have a multiple-choice listening task, underline key words in each question before you look at the options.

4 Study the listening strategy. Read questions 1–5 and underline key words in the questions.

- 1 Who do teenagers listen to most for advice, according to the presenter?
a pop stars b their parents c YouTubers
- 2 How many followers on YouTube do you need to start earning money?
a 500,000 b 17,000 c 1 million
- 3 How do YouTubers make money?
a They sell video games. c They work for one company.
b They have ads on their channel.
- 4 How are YouTubers similar to their followers?
a They have special talents. c They have similar life experiences.
b They are open and honest.
- 5 What do YouTubers do when they talk to their followers?
a They often film private conversations. c They ask their fans a lot of questions.
b They usually film themselves in a personal space.



5 Listen again and choose the best answers (a–c) to the questions in exercise 4. Did underlining key words help you?



6 Read the role cards and act out dialogues. Use the key phrases below to help you.



1

Student A You belong to a cycling club. Your friend has a new bike and you think he/she would really enjoy the club. Think of ways to influence your friend so that he/she joins the club.

Student B Your friend wants you to join his/her cycling club. You aren't really interested – you have other hobbies and don't have much time for exercising.

2

Student A There is a new student in your class who doesn't speak English well and seems lonely. You want to invite the student to spend the day with you and your best friend this weekend, but your friend doesn't like the idea. Think of ways to influence them to include the new student.

Student B Your best friend has invited a new student to spend the day with you on Saturday. You don't want someone new to join you – you think it will be less fun.

Key phrases Influencing people

Have you considered ... ?

Perhaps you could

You might not realize this, but ...

OK, you've persuaded me.

Sorry, I'm not convinced.

7 REFLECT Think about a situation in your life when you tried to influence a friend or family member. Were you successful? What would you do differently now?

Discover
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SEARCH ONLINE and watch some videos by a YouTuber that you like. What strategies do they use to influence and persuade their followers?